Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

928
-16 -1.69%
Oct 23rd, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1040
-16.00 -1.52%
Oct 23rd, 2023

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

867
-2 -0.23%
Oct 23rd, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

108.25
0.00 0.00%
Oct 23rd, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

138.95
0.00 0.00%
Oct 23rd, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1132
49 4.52%
Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2401 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

835.00
-4.00 -0.48%
Oct 23rd, 2023 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
November 23 USD/dmt

110.85
0.50 0.45%
Oct 23rd, 2023 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2401 (Jan) RMB/t

3572
-38 -1.05%
Oct 23rd, 2023 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

25.77
-0.63 -2.38%
Oct 20th, 2023

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

10.70
-0.08 -0.74%
Oct 20th, 2023

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

3730
10 0.27%
Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

105.01
-0.55 -0.52%
Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

11.46
-0.67 -5.50%
Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

3750
10 0.27%
Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Oct 23rd, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	928	-16.0	-1.69%	869	880	858	892	120.59	-2.14	-1.7%	120.06	120.58	117.93	122.93
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	867	-2.0	-0.23%	813	798	761	793	113.65	-0.27	-0.2%	113.29	110.17	105.29	110.04
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1040	-16.0	-1.52%	981	992	970	1003	135.59	-2.14	-1.6%	136.05	136.43	133.84	138.73

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Oct 23rd, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	108.25	0.00	0.00%	113.24	113.24	83.90	146.75
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	138.95	0.00	0.00%	124.70	124.70	94.45	147.55

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures declined by 2.45 % today, the main contract closed at 835. The steel mills are active to purchase.The overall trading sentiment of the market is less. PBF at Shandong port deal 898 yuan/mt. PBF at Tangshan port deal 930 yuan/mt. Yesterday, it was reported that Tangshan blast furnace enterprises have limited the production of sintering machines by 30%, and entered the heating season in the fourth quarter. Environmental protection requirements have gradually been stricter in the same period of previous years, but it does not affect blast furnace production. Therefore, this news mainly affects the amount of coarse powder used, and blocks and balls play a certain substitute role. Fundamentally speaking, the total global iron ore shipment this week was 31.75 million tons, a decrease of 4% compared to the previous week. The total arrival of iron ore in China was 27.5979 million tons, an increase of 13.4% compared to the previous week. However, it is difficult for steel mills to improve operating rates and blast furnace capacity utilization due to poor profits, resulting in a relaxed overall supply and demand pattern. Last week's macro news and demand for finished products drove iron ore prices higher. As sentiment digested and iron ore valuations returned to rationality, and as demand gradually turned light, downstream capacity and willingness to undertake high prices may decline. Overall, iron ore prices may move downwards this week.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1132	49	4.5%	944	1019	770	1132	141.75	6.26	4.62%	120.47	134.93	94.72	141.75

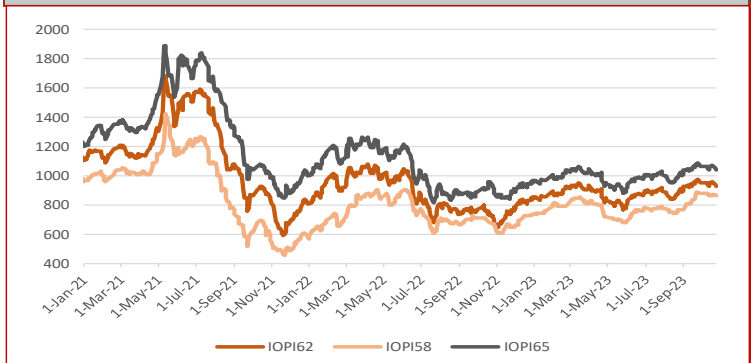
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1051	-2.1%	779	1645	146.39	-2.07%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1105	1.4%	780	1630	153.91	1.35%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	805	-1.2%	620	1310	112.12	-1.25%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1124	-2.6%	800	1752	156.56	-2.62%	117.19	272.32

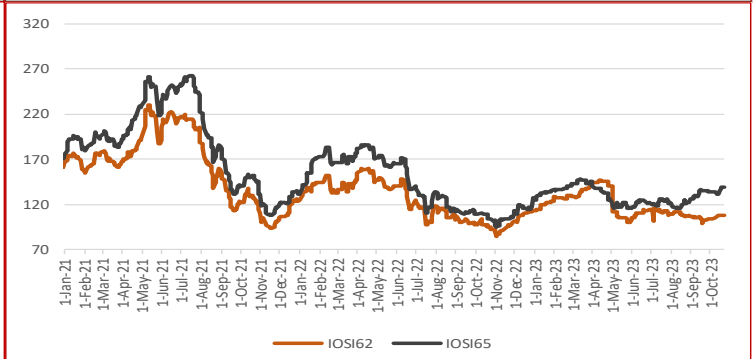
Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	984.27	-0.73%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.87528

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Oct 23rd, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	863	896	873	945	869	881	880	112.38	116.58	113.28	122.79	120.06	120.90	120.58
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	748	777	759	838	813	792	798	97.98	101.68	99.13	109.67	113.29	109.35	110.17
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	975	1008	985	1057	981	993	992	127.41	131.57	128.31	137.74	136.05	136.72	136.43

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Oct 23rd, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	110.54	108.57	109.02	104.25	112.14	112.31	113.24
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	135.30	147.39	119.61	132.40	122.86	123.87	124.70

FREIGHT RATES

Oct 20th, 2023		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	10.70	-0.08	-0.74%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	25.77	-0.63	-2.38%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD	June	July	August	September	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	969	980	951	1043	933	941	1017	121.33	122.51	118.96	130.25	119.96	120.46	134.98

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Oct 23rd, 2023		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-61	-6.57%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	112	12.07%

Oct 23rd, 2023		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	30.70	28.36%

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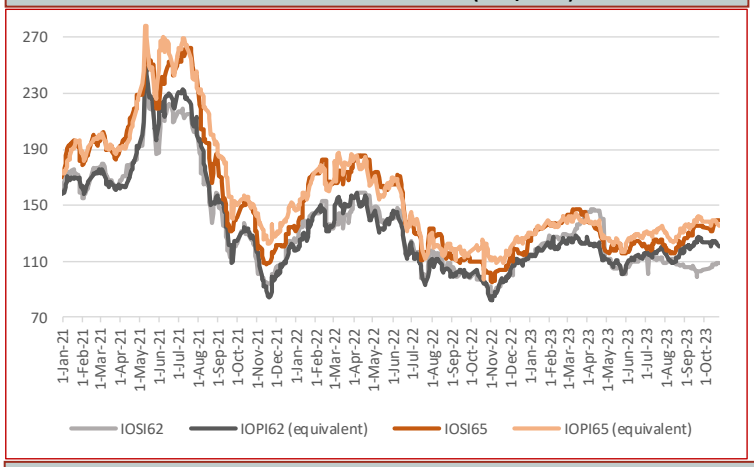
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Oct 23rd, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	871	-16	-57
SIMEC Fines	802	-16	-126
PB Fines	895	-16	-33
Newman Fines	897	-16	-31
MAC Fines	878	-16	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	793	-17	-135
Carajas Fines	1109	-16	181
Brazilian SSF	893	-17	-35
Brazilian Blend Fines	909	-16	-19
RTX Fines	811	-16	-117
West Pilbara Fines	839	-16	-89

Oct 23rd, 2023	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	103.75	0.00	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	100.25	0.00	-8.00
PB Fines	104.50	0.00	-3.75
Newman Fines	107.40	0.00	-0.85
MAC Fines	104.50	0.00	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	96.90	0.00	-11.35
Carajas Fines	137.80	0.00	29.55
Brazilian SSF	112.00	0.00	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	113.65	0.00	5.40
RTX Fines	98.15	0.00	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	102.50	0.00	-5.75

Oct 23rd, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	867	-2	0
FMG Blended Fines	878	-2	11
Robe River	879	-2	12
Western Fines	882	-2	15
Atlas Fines	875	-2	8
Yandi	859	-2	-8

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	10.00	4.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	10.00	4.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	10.00	4.00
	Low Grade Fe	15.00	-1.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	10.00	-5.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	12.00	-8.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	12.00	1.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade	5.00	-2.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	5.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.25	0.25
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	2.75	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	2.75	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	2.75	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	3.00	0.75
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	0.75	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	2.75	-0.25
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.50	-0.50
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	4.00	-0.50

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-30.00	-15.00	Jingtang	-5.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-30.00	0.00

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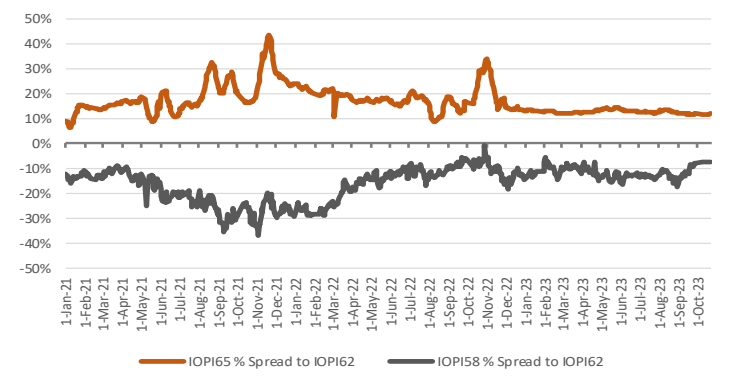
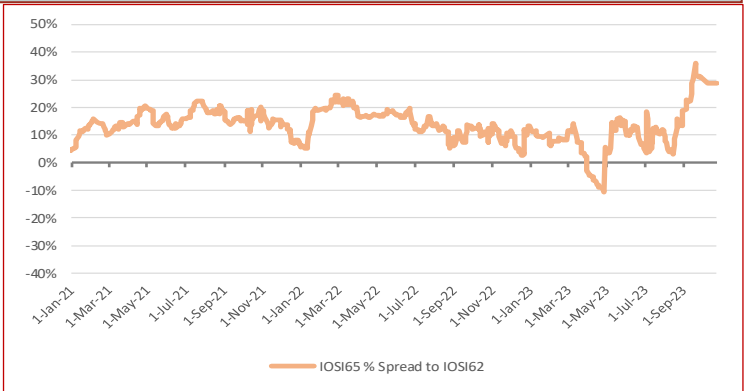
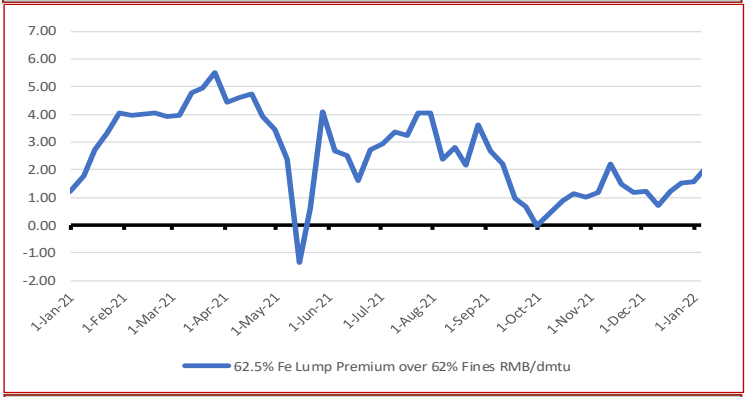
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

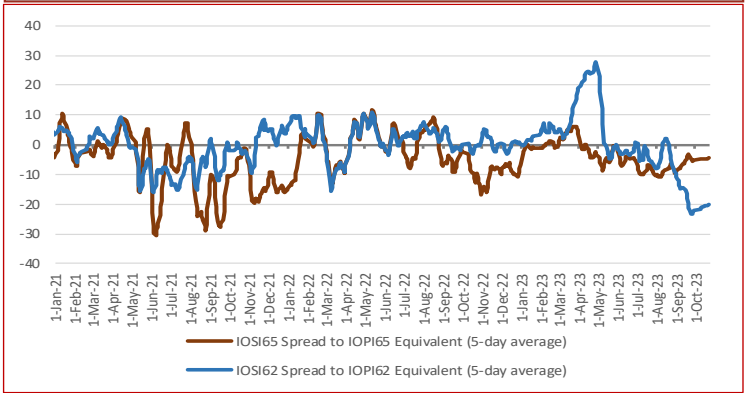




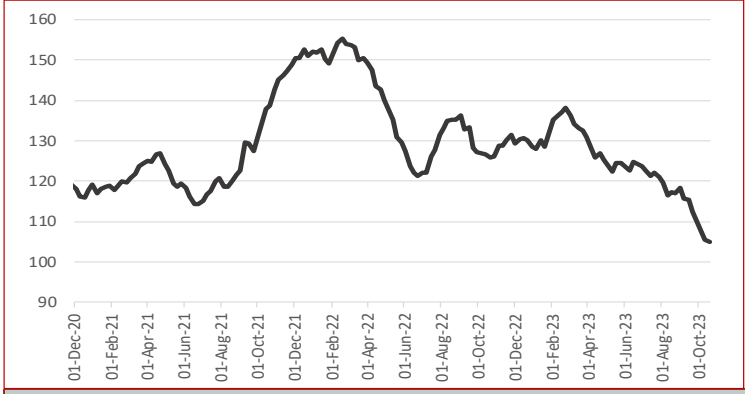
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



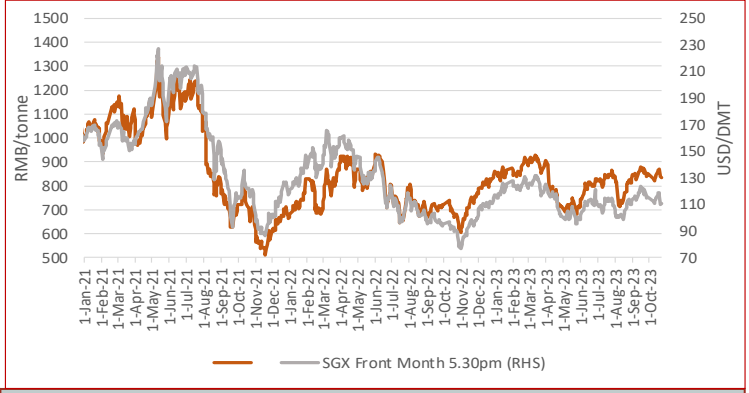
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

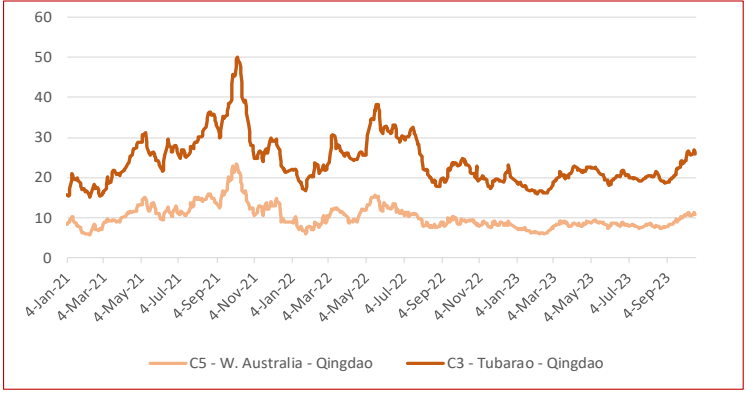
Week Ending Oct 20th, 2023

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	8.70	-10.31%	8.70	19.20
Qingdao	23.88	0.93%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	9.58	13.78%	8.42	16.29
Tianjin	6.49	-2.26%	6.49	12.97
Rizhao	12.20	5.90%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	105.01	-0.52%	98.80	155.39

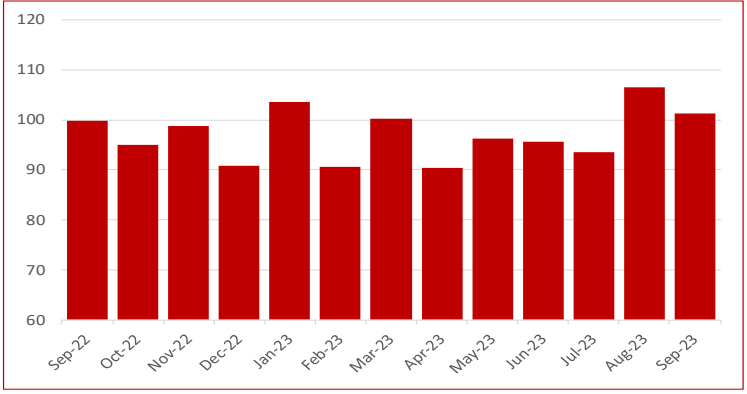
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Oct 23rd, 3pm close			Oct 23rd, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2401	Change	Change %	Nov. 23	Change	Change %
Closing Price	835.00	-4.00	-0.48%	110.85	0.50	0.45%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	55.13	-18.25	-24.87%	7.43	-1.92	-20.50%
Open positions ('000 lots)	80.10	-0.99	-1.22%	38.29	0.70	1.87%
Day Low	825.5	-11.50	-1.37%	110.70	-1.50	-1.34%
Day High	842.5	-31.00	-3.55%	113.55	-3.70	-3.16%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2023/10/20	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	3,730	10	0.27%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	3,930	10	0.26%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	3,750	10	0.27%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,800	-50	-1.03%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	3,760	0	0.00%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	5,050	-40	-0.79%
Colour Coated Plate	6,950	0	0.00%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

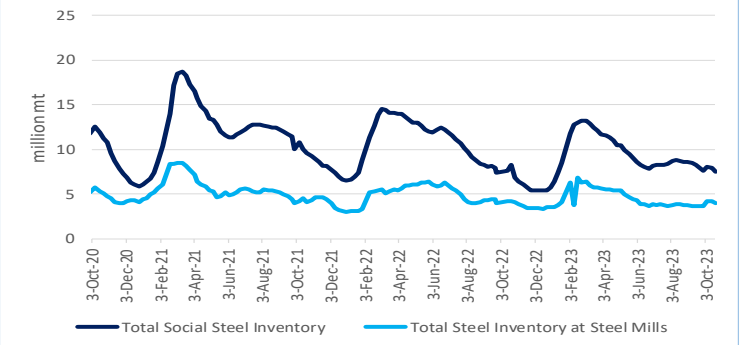
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	107.83	5	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	2,560	110	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	2,890	-80	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,254	-2	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	3,903	-3	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-263	-78	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	3,961	7	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	-221	-137	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

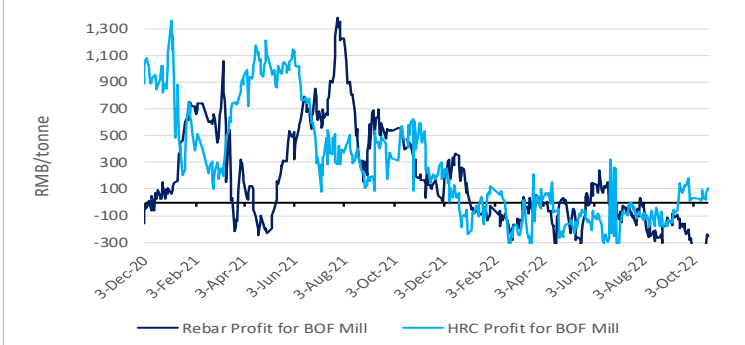
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

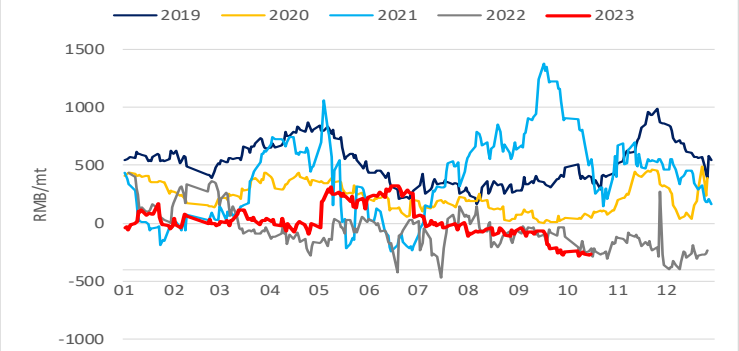
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



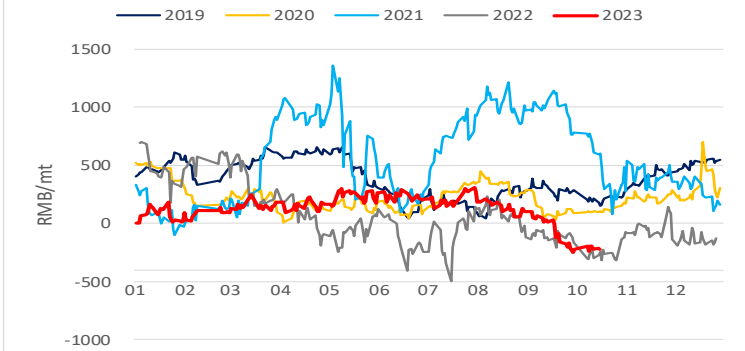
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



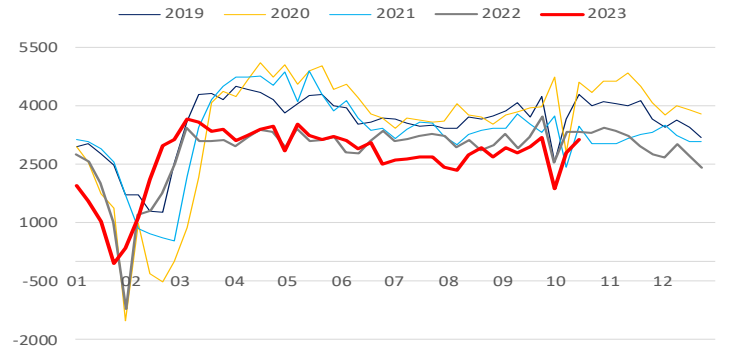
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



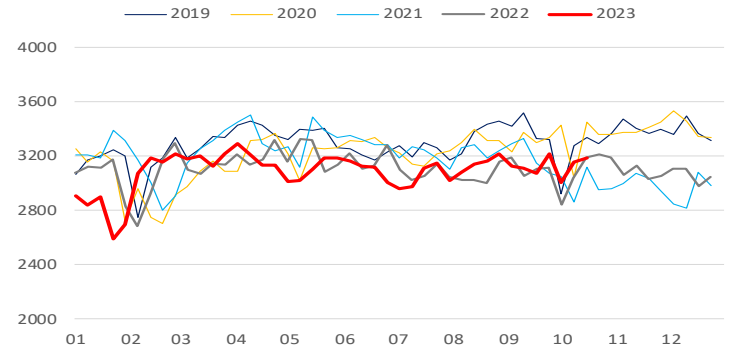
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



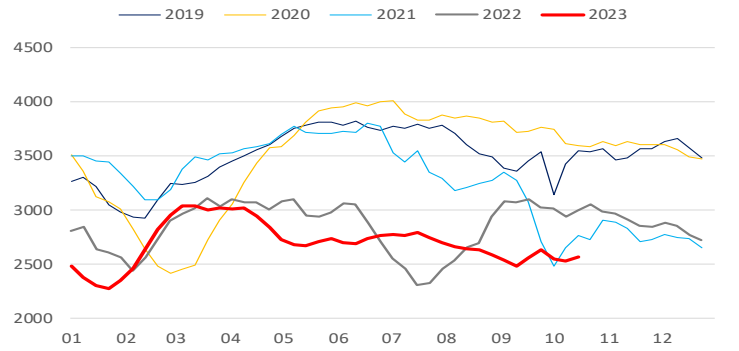
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



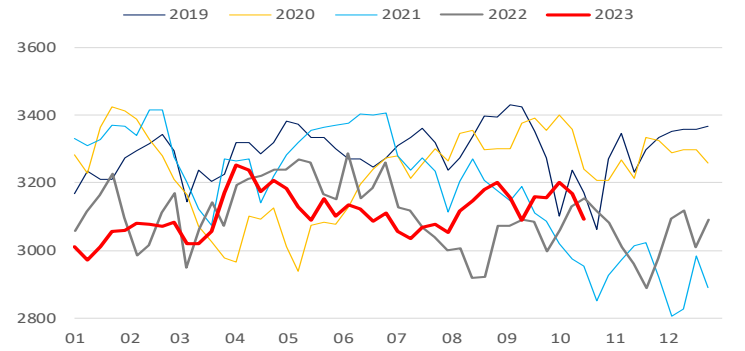
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Oct 23rd, 2023	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Oct 23rd, 2023	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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